Jessy Wang

jessywang0w0@gmail.com | Boston, MA |
| Website: JessyWangSun.github.io Researcher in Responsible AI — examining how AI outputs shape user trust, reliance, and psychological responses in high-risk contexts.

EDUCATION

Boston University, Boston, MA — Sept 2023 – Present
Co-advised under Massachusetts Institute of Technology Media Lab, Cambridge, MA
Ph.D. Candidate, Emerging Media Studies (GPA: 3.8 / 4.0)

New York University, New York, NY — Sept 2019 – Jul 2021
M.A., Media, Culture, and Communication (GPA: 3.8 / 4.0)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

HCLTech, Remote — Jun 2026 – Present
AI Research Intern — Enterprise Child Safety

- Translated behavioral addiction and dependency research into five observable indicators of AI overreliance, with annotation rules linking theory to evidence in chat messages
- Built a Python pipeline that turns LLM message scores into daily frequencies and 14-day trends, tracking behavioral patterns over time with every result traceable to source messages
- Defined annotation rules and a human review process to curate a dataset from a large conversation corpus, with user-level splits and annotator agreement checks
- Ran three LoRA fine-tuning experiments on Qwen 4B and 7B models, evaluating each behavioral indicator and identifying limited positive examples as a key barrier to reliable classification

Roblox Corporation, San Mateo, CA — Aug 2025 – Present
Grant Researcher

- Developed a multi-level toxicity framework for real-time classification of harmful language in online gaming chat
- Built a three-stage LLM moderation pipeline (category detection → edge-case policy filtering → verdict synthesis), balancing coverage, precision, and response latency in live environments

Personal Robots Group — MIT Media Lab, Cambridge, MA — Sept 2023 – Present
Graduate Researcher

- Co-designed an AI interaction framework with school counselors to keep model outputs safe and developmentally appropriate for adolescent users
- Developed iterative reflection loops where the model summarizes user input and generates follow-up prompts to support continued self-reflection

BriteBound (formerly American Student Association), Boston, MA — Sept 2025 – Present
Research Consultant

- Led a national study of youth AI usage (N = 9,000), analyzing how socioeconomic and educational environments shape AI adoption, reliance, and literacy; authored the resulting white paper

New York State Office of Mental Health, New York, NY — Aug 2021 – Apr 2022
Crisis Counselor

- Delivered real-time crisis support to emotionally vulnerable populations, applying de-escalation, validation, and non-directive support

New York University, Department of Applied Psychology, New York, NY — Aug 2021 – Apr 2022
Research Assistant

- Developed a chatbot-based intervention to support college access for low-income high school students, this intervention focusing on

FELLOWSHIPS AND AWARDS

Merit Fellowship, Boston University — Full PhD funding (~$400,000) 2023
Segall Innovation Fellowship — National AI education research grant, $25,000 2025
Top Faculty-Led Paper Award, ICA Children, Adolescents & Media Division 2026

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

- **Wang, J.**, Sun, Y., & Zhang, H. (2026). AI as Social Support: How Real-World Support and Well-Being Shape User Reliance on Conversational AI. *Affective Computing and Intelligent Interaction 2026* .
- **Wang, J.**, & Wu, D. (2026). How Does AI Companionship Shape Subjective Wellbeing? A Scoping Review of Emerging Evidence. *AEJMC 2026*.
- **Wang, J.**, AlAyyaf, S. A., et al. (2026). Co-Designing Digital Learning Games with School Counselors. *ACM IDC '26*.
- Additional peer-reviewed work at ACM IDC '26, ICA '25, and NEPA '25. Full list: JessyWangSun.github.io

TECHNICAL & ANALYTICAL SKILLS

Programming: Python, R, SQL; LLM APIs, fine-tuning, prompt and pipeline engineering, evaluation harness design
Analytics: Regression analysis, A/B testing, experimental design, survey design, mixed-methods
Research: LLM safety evaluation, content classification, adversarial/red-team testing, HCI (participatory design, user testing), AI ethics and policy translation